

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 9 5
 ♥ K 9 8 3
 ♦ Q J 9 5 3
 ♣ 6

♠ A K 8 7 4 2

♥ A 6

♦ A 10 2

♣ 5 3



♠ J 10
 ♥ Q J 10 2
 ♦ K 8
 ♣ 10 9 8 4 2

♠ 6 3

♥ 7 5 4

♦ 7 6 4

♣ A K Q J 7

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♣
Pass	3 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			

4 ♠ by North

the rest of the tricks are yours because you can run the ♣ suit without anyone trumping in.

Of course you open 1 ♠. Partner responds 2 ♣.

With 17 points and a 6-card suit you jump to 3 ♠. Partner bids the game.

North plays 4 ♠. East leads the ♥ Q.

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Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 0 : Total = 4

You have plenty of ♣ winners in dummy but you must be careful because there are no outside entries. You win your ♥ A and play ♠ A and ♠ K, both defenders following suit. The ♠ Q is still out. To make sure you get to enjoy those ♣ winners you should continue with another ♠, forcing out the ♠ Q. The defense will now take a ♥ if they are smart, but

Think through what would have happened if you had not forced out the ♠ Q.

West would have used his master ♠ Q to ruff the second ♣, before you had taken any discards. You would still have to lose a ♥ and two ♦ s.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A J 3
 ♥ 10 8 6 4
 ♦ Q 9 6 5
 ♣ 8 7

♠ Q 10 7

♥ K 9 5

♦ J 10 8 3

♣ K Q 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 8 6 4

♥ Q J 3

♦ A K 2

♣ A 9 5

♠ 9 5 2

♥ A 7 2

♦ 7 4

♣ J 10 6 4 3

West

North

East

South

1NT

All Pass

1NT by East

Winners: ♠ 2 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 3 : ♣ 1 : Total = 6

You only need one more winner and there are possibilities in ♠s, ♥s and ♦s. But you need to be very careful. If you watched those ♣ spots you will realize that South started with 5 ♣s (he led the ♣4, later played the ♣3). So the defenders will win 2 more ♣ tricks to go with the 2 they already have. And they can also take the ♥A and ♥K whenever they want. In other words, they also have 6 winners. So the battle is for the 7th trick for either side. If you do anything that gives them a trick they will win.

So you don't try for a trick in ♠s or ♦s. Instead you play on ♥s, the suit where they have the 2 sure winners anyway. They will win one of their high honors, take their 2 ♣s, then play either ♠s or ♦s. You win and drive out the other ♥ honor.

If you try to get a winner by taking the ♠ finesse you will give **THEM** a winner and you will go down.

If you play your three high ♦s you will set up a winner for **THEM** and you will go down.

Only if you establish your ♥s can you set up a winner for **YOU** without giving them an extra trick.

West's 1NT opening shows a maximum of 17 points. Add your 7 and you come up with only 24 - not enough to think about game. So you pass.

West would play 1NT.

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East plays 1NT. South leads the ♣4. North plays the ♣Q, then the ♣K, South playing the ♣3 on the second trick. North then plays the ♣2 which you win with your ♣A.

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